

Autumn Leaves

Daily Practice Plan + Workbook

G Major / E Minor · ~100 BPM · 4 Weeks · 60 min/day

S1

PLOGGER

Ch.3 Mastery
Ch.4 Longy Full

10 min

S2

INTEGRATED

Melody + Harmony
+ Voicings Deep

18 min

S3

SONG WORK

Autumn Leaves
Full Cycle

14 min

S4

JAMMING

Free Play
+ Clave

10 min

S5

SYNTHESIZER

Connect +
Reflect

8 min

ANCHOR SONG — SPRINT 2

Autumn Leaves

Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 → Cmaj7 → F#m7b5 → B7 → Em (full cycle in G maj + E min)

This song is in your ears all sprint. **Hear it before you touch your instrument.** Every drill comes back here.

Non-Negotiable Rule: Hear before you play. Sing before you play.

Every exercise in every section begins with your inner ear or your voice. Never let your fingers lead.

PLOGGER
12 notes eyes-closed <2s

MELODY
4 behaviors by ear in song

HARMONY
I-IV-V-I + I-V-vi-IV both inst.

RHYTHM
Longy full system 80 BPM

SONG
AL verse both instruments

Sprint 2 Focus Areas

PRIMARY — MUSICAL OS

- Plogger Ch.3: Keyboard Visualization — all 12 chromatic notes by landmark, eyes-closed, under 2 seconds
- Plogger Ch.4: Longy Rhythms — complete system including dotted and syncopated patterns

PRIMARY — MELODY CHAMBER

- Stability ladder deepened (all four zones, all chord qualities)
- Four chord-change behaviors: Stay Sweet, Turn Tense, Float Free, Sink Deeper

SECONDARY — HARMONY CHAMBER

- Progression #1: I-IV-V-I (fundamental cadence) introduced
- Progression #2: I-V-vi-IV ("four chord song") introduced
- Both progressions in G major on both instruments

VOICINGS — DEEPENING ONLY

- No new voicing concepts this sprint
- Root position + inversions from Sprint 1 applied to Autumn Leaves chord set

Read this entire page before your first practice session of the week. These are the ideas your exercises will build.

MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER

Ch.3: Every Note Has a Landmark

The keyboard is not a random row of keys. Black keys come in groups of 2 and 3. Every white note lives next to a specific black-key group. **D is the lone white key between the two black keys.** F is the first white key left of the three black keys. Once your eyes (and fingers) lock onto these landmarks, you can find any note in under 2 seconds — and eventually with your eyes closed. **Week 1 goal:** Name and locate C, D, E, F, G, A, B instantly. Use the black-key groups as anchors, not note names alone.

MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER CH.4

Longy Rhythms: The Speaking System

Every rhythm has a spoken syllable. **ta** = quarter note. **ta-te** = two eighth notes. **ta-fe-te-fe** = four sixteenth notes. **ta---te** = dotted quarter + eighth. This week: master ta, ta-te, and ta-fe-te-fe. Speak every rhythm before you clap it, and clap before you play it. *Hear before you play — even rhythm lives in your inner ear first.*

MELODY CHAMBER — STABILITY LADDER

Four Zones Over Any Chord

Every note you could play over a chord sits in one of four zones: **Zone 1 (Sweet)** — chord tones, always stable. **Zone 2 (Tension)** — half-step above a chord tone, maximum pull. **Zone 3 (Color)** — whole step above, adds flavor without urgency. **Zone 4 (Passing)** — moves through quickly, doesn't land. Week 1: identify zones on the Am7 and Gmaj7 chords in Autumn Leaves.

MELODY CHAMBER — CHORD-CHANGE BEHAVIORS

What Happens to Your Note When the Chord Changes?

STAY SWEET Your note was a chord tone. New chord arrives. Your note is <i>still</i> a chord tone. Nothing changed — pure smoothness.	TURN TENSE Your note was sweet. New chord arrives. Your note is now a half-step clash. The music <i>wants</i> you to move.
FLOAT FREE Your note was sweet. New chord arrives. Your note is now a whole-step color tone. You have freedom — stay or move.	SINK DEEPER Your note was already color. New chord arrives. Your note becomes even more unstable. Strong pull to resolve.

This week: hear each behavior on Am7 → D7. Name it out loud. Sing before you play.

HARMONY CHAMBER — NEW THIS WEEK

I-IV-V-I: The Fundamental Cadence

In G major: **G – C – D – G**. This is the foundation of Western harmony. The I chord is home. IV is a step away — warmer, fuller. V is tension — it aches to return. I resolves. **This is not a drill vehicle — it is an emotional arc.** Every time you play it, feel the journey: home → away → longing → home. Also introduced: **I-V-vi-IV** in G major: G – D – Em – C. The "four chord song." Notice the vi (Em) — that is the relative minor, the same world as E minor in Autumn Leaves. Same notes, different gravity.

AUTUMN LEAVES — WEEK 1 THREAD

The First Four Chords: Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 → Cmaj7

This is the ii-V-I-IV in G major. Listen to a recording and follow these four chords. The Am7 is the ii (two chord) — it sets up tension. D7 is the V7 — maximum pull. Gmaj7 is home in G major. Cmaj7 is the warm IV. **Every drill this week connects back to this four-chord passage.** *Hear before you play — listen to the first 8 bars of Autumn Leaves before every practice session this week.*

**Guitar**

RETURNING INTERMEDIATE · TRAVIS PICKING STAGE 1-2 · REBUILDING MUSCLE MEMORY

WEEK 1

1 SECTION 1**Plogger Foundation — Ch.3 Mastery + Ch.4 Longy Full System**

10 min

KEYBOARD LANDMARK DRILL STAGE 1

3 min

Hear before you play. Before touching the guitar, find your keyboard (phone app is fine). Call out each white key by name using the black-key landmark rule.

- D is between the 2 black keys — find it, say "D" aloud
- F is left of the 3 black keys — find it, say "F"
- Drill all 7 white keys (C D E F G A B) in random order: point → say
- Week 1 target: all 7 white keys under 2 seconds each

LONGY SPEAK + CLAP — AUTUMN LEAVES RHYTHM STAGE 1

4 min

Hear the rhythm in your head first. Hum the first phrase of Autumn Leaves. Now speak it in Longy syllables.

- **Pattern A (bar 1-2):** Speak: "ta . ta . ta-te ta . " — tap foot on beats
- **Pattern B (dotted):** Speak: "ta---te ta ta" — feel the long-short pull
- Clap the pattern. Then speak+clap together at 60 BPM (slow is correct)
- Apply to guitar: muted strings only — right hand taps rhythm while left mutes

TRAVIS THUMB ACTIVATION STAGE 1

3 min

- Open G chord. Thumb alternates: string 6 (beat 1) → string 4 (beat 2) → string 6 (3) → string 4 (4)
- Speak "ta" on every thumb stroke. Keep it absolutely steady at 60 BPM
- No other fingers yet — thumb only. Lock in the bass pendulum.
- Transition to Am7: thumb on string 5 (beat 1) and string 4 (beat 2)

2 SECTION 2**Integrated Work — Melody + Harmony + Voicings**

18 min

ZONE IDENTIFICATION ON GUITAR NECK STAGE 1

5 min

Sing before you play. Sing "Am7" then hum each chord tone (A-C-E-G) before touching the guitar.

- Hold Am7 chord. Identify: root (A), third (C), fifth (E), seventh (G) — these are Zone 1 (Sweet)
- On high E string: walk up from open E — name each note's zone over Am7 (open E = Zone 1 fifth; F = Zone 2; G = Zone 1 seventh; A = Zone 1 root)
- Repeat same walk over Gmaj7 chord — same string, new zones
- Name each zone out loud as you play it: "sweet, tense, sweet, color..."

CHORD-CHANGE BEHAVIOR — AM7 TO D7 STAGE 2

5 min

Hear before you play. Sing the note G (the 7th of Am7). Hold it in your head. Now mentally land on D7 — what happens?

- Play G note on high E (3rd fret). Strum Am7 — G is Zone 1 (Sweet). Strum D7 — G is now the minor 7th... Float Free (whole step above F#).
- Now try E (5th fret high E). Am7: Zone 1. D7: Zone 2 (half step above chord tone D — Turn Tense!)
- Name the behavior aloud each time: "Stay Sweet / Turn Tense / Float Free / Sink Deeper"
- Connect to Autumn Leaves: the melody note in bar 1 — which behavior does it experience at the chord change?

I-IV-V-I IN G MAJOR — GUITAR SHAPES STAGE 1

5 min

Hear before you play. Hum G-C-D-G in your head. Feel the pull of D wanting to go back to G.

G (open) → **C (x32010)** → **D (xx0232)** → **G (open)**

- Play each chord as a simple strum, 4 beats each, at 70 BPM
- Strum down only — feel the arc: home → fuller → tension → home
- Say the Roman numeral as you play: "I... IV... V... I..."
- Then: I-V-vi-IV = G → D → Em → C — play same way, say numerals aloud

VOICINGS DEEPENING — AM7 INVERSIONS STAGE 2

3 min

Sing before you play. Sing A-C-E-G (Am7 tones) before playing any inversion.

- Root position Am7: x02010. Identify root (A) in bass.
- First inversion (C in bass): x32010-like shape — find it on neck, confirm C is lowest sounding note
- No jumping more than a 4th between chord changes. Voice-lead: keep common tones where possible



Guitar — Week 1

SECTIONS 3–5

WEEK 1

3

SECTION 3

Song Learning — Autumn Leaves Verse Progression

14 min

LISTEN + MAP — AUTUMN LEAVES FIRST 16 BARS

STAGE 1

3 min

Hear before you play. Play a recording. Follow along — no guitar yet.

- Listen for the four-chord cycle in G major: Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 → Cmaj7
- Tap your foot on beats 1 and 3 (strong beats in 4/4)
- At bar 5 the cycle shifts to E minor: F#m7b5 → B7 → Em — notice the color change
- Sing along to the melody on "la" — feel where the phrases land

AM7-D7-GMAJ7-CMAJ7 CHORD TRANSITIONS

STAGE 2

6 min

Sing before you play each chord. Hum its root note first.

- Play each chord for 2 bars (8 beats) at 70 BPM. Down strums only.
- Focus on smooth transitions: find the pivot finger (which finger stays put between chords?)
- Am7 → D7: middle finger anchors on string 2, fret 1 for Am7; moves to string 1 for D7
- D7 → Gmaj7: practice this change 8× in a row before continuing
- Add voice economy: look for nearest voicing, not lowest chord shape

FULL VERSE — FINGERPICKING PATTERN ENTRY

STAGE 2

5 min

Hear before you play. Speak "ta ta-te ta ta" (the groove pattern) before every chord change.

- Apply Travis thumb (alternating bass) to Autumn Leaves chord sequence
- Pattern: p (thumb bass) → i → m → i on each beat subdivision at 70 BPM
- First 4 chords only (Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 → Cmaj7) — loop this until smooth
- Goal: changes feel automatic before adding second 4-chord cycle (F#m7b5 → B7 → Em)

4

SECTION 4

Jamming / Free Play — Groove + Clave

10 min

FREE STRUM OVER I-IV-V-I — FEEL THE ARC

STAGE 2

5 min

- Set a 80 BPM metronome. Play G-C-D-G freely — no set strumming pattern
- Start boring (all down strums). Then add one anticipation per bar. Then add a stop.
- Listen to the harmony with your ears: does this feel like Autumn Leaves territory?
- **Sing before you play** the next chord change — hum it, then play it

SON CLAVE CLAP + GUITAR RESPONSE

STAGE 2

5 min

- Clap 3-2 Son Clave: beats 1, 2+, 3 in bar 1; beats 1.5 and 3 in bar 2
- Speak "Clave" on each clap while keeping foot on downbeats
- Now: play an Am7 strum only on clave hit positions — silence elsewhere
- This is groove development: the guitar answers the clave, not the metronome

5

SECTION 5

The Synthesizer — Connect + Reflect

8 min

CROSS-SYSTEM CONNECTION CIRCUIT

STAGE 3

5 min

- Pick one melody note from Autumn Leaves bar 1. Name its Longy rhythm position (ta? te? fe?)
- Name its keyboard landmark position (what note is it? where does it sit relative to black keys?)
- Name its zone over the Am7 chord (Sweet / Tense / Color / Passing)
- Name the behavior when D7 arrives (Stay Sweet / Turn Tense / Float Free / Sink Deeper)
- This is the Synthesizer circuit: Plogger → Melody → Harmony → Song — all connected

ONE-SENTENCE REFLECTION

STAGE 3

3 min

- What did your ears notice today that your fingers didn't know yet?
- What felt automatic? What required conscious thought?
- Write one sentence in your workbook. This is your compass for tomorrow's session.

**Piano**

ADVANCED BEGINNER · INVERSIONS + VOICE ECONOMY ESTABLISHED

WEEK 1

1 SECTION 1

1 Plogger Foundation — Ch.3 Mastery + Ch.4 Longy Full System

10 min

KEYBOARD LANDMARK EYES-CLOSED DRILL STAGE 1

4 min

Hear before you play. Before touching keys, visualize the full keyboard in your mind — see the black-key groups.

- Eyes open: play middle C, D, E, F, G, A, B using only black-key group anchors (no reading names)
- Eyes closed: place one finger on D (the white key between the two black keys). Confirm. Now find F. G. A.
- Week 1 goal: all 7 white keys in random order, eyes closed, under 2 seconds each
- Use Plogger di-chord naming: "D is the lone key, C is its left neighbor" — say it aloud

LONGY SPEAK + KEYBOARD STAGE 1

3 min

Hear before you play. Hum the Autumn Leaves melody, then convert it to Longy syllables before touching the keys.

- Speak "ta ta-te ta ta" while tapping your knee — get the syllables precise
- Now play a single note (G, middle octave) with RH and speak each syllable as it lands
- Then apply the rhythm to scale walk: C-D-E-F with ta-ta-ta-te pattern

HEPTACHORD FORMATION — AM AND G MAJOR STAGE 1

3 min

- RH: play A-B-C-D-E-F-G (A natural minor heptachord) slowly, speaking each note aloud
- LH: same exercise, one octave lower — left hand shapes mirror the right
- Then G major: G-A-B-C-D-E-F#, both hands, say each note name using landmark system
- This is not a scale drill — it is a landscape survey. You are mapping the territory of Autumn Leaves.

2 SECTION 2

2 Integrated Work — Melody + Harmony + Voicings

18 min

ZONE MAPPING ON PIANO — AM7 AND GMAJ7 STAGE 1

5 min

Sing before you play. Hum the tones A-C-E-G (Am7). Sing them before touching keys.

- LH: hold Am7 block chord (A-C-E-G). RH: walk up white keys starting from A, naming each zone
- A = Zone 1 (root / Sweet). B = Zone 3 (Color). C = Zone 1 (third). D = Zone 3. E = Zone 1 (fifth). F = Zone 2 (Tense). G = Zone 1 (seventh)
- Speak each zone as you land: "Sweet... Color... Sweet... Color... Sweet... Tense... Sweet..."
- Repeat over Gmaj7: what changes? What stays the same?

CHORD-CHANGE BEHAVIOR — PIANO SLOW MOTION STAGE 2

5 min

Hear before you play. Hold the melody note in your inner ear before the chord changes under it.

- Hold G (right hand, single note) while LH plays Am7 → D7 slowly
- G over Am7: Zone 1 (seventh — Sweet). G over D7: Zone 4 (minor 7th — Float Free)
- Now try E: Am7 = Zone 1 (fifth). D7 = Zone 2 (half-step above D# enharmonic — Turn Tense)
- Name behavior aloud at each change: "Float Free... Turn Tense..."
- Apply to Autumn Leaves bar 1: what behavior does the actual melody note experience?

I-IV-V-I IN G MAJOR — SHELL VOICINGS LH STAGE 1

5 min

Hear before you play. Sing G-C-D-G before playing. Feel home → away → tension → home.

- LH only: G (root, low) → C (root) → D (root) → G. Simple root bass, 4 beats each
- Add shell: LH plays root + fifth for each chord (G-D, C-G, D-A, G-D)
- RH: add the third on top (G chord = B on top; C chord = E; D chord = F#; G = B)
- Say Roman numerals as you play: "I... IV... V... I..."
- Then I-V-vi-IV: G → D → Em → C — same process. Name vi as "the relative minor world of Autumn Leaves"

SHELL VOICINGS — AM7 SPRINT 1 DEEPENING STAGE 2

3 min

Sing before you play. Sing A-C-G (Am7 shell) before playing it.

- Am7 shell: A (LH) — C-G (RH, 3rd and 7th). This is the "open" voicing — no fifth, maximum clarity
- Voice-lead to D7 shell: D (LH) — C-F# (RH). Notice C stays → float. F# rises to resolve G
- To Gmaj7 shell: G (LH) — F#-B (RH). One step: C resolves to B. Economy of motion.
- Practice Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 as a three-chord loop, RH never jumping more than a 4th

**Piano — Week 1**

SECTIONS 3–5

WEEK 1

3

SECTION 3

Song Learning — Autumn Leaves Verse Progression

14 min

LISTEN + VISUALIZE — AUTUMN LEAVES ON KEYS STAGE 1

3 min

Hear before you play. Listen to a recording with your hands in lap. Visualize the chord roots moving on the keyboard.

- Follow: A (Am7) → D (D7) → G (Gmaj7) → C (Cmaj7) → F# (F#m7b5) → B (B7) → E (Em)
- Tap each root on your lap as it arrives — no sound, just the mapping
- Listen for the moment the music shifts from G major feeling to E minor feeling (bar 5)

LH PATTERN — ROOT BASS THROUGH FULL CYCLE STAGE 2

6 min

Sing before you play each root. Hum the root before your LH plays it.

- LH only: play root bass on beat 1 of each chord, 2-bar chords at 70 BPM
- Sequence: A → D → G → C → F# → B → E (two beats of silence) → repeat
- Feel the root motion: mostly descending by 4ths (A-D-G-C). This is the engine of Western harmony.
- Add blocked chord (root + 5th in LH) once root-only feels automatic

RH SHELL VOICINGS — SMOOTH THROUGH FULL CYCLE STAGE 2

5 min

Hear before you play. Hear the next chord sound in your head before your hands move.

- RH shell voicings (3rd + 7th): Am7 (C-G) → D7 (C-F#, C stays!) → Gmaj7 (F#-B, F# stays!) → Cmaj7 (E-B, B stays!)
- Notice: common tones create "voice-leading" — minimum motion, maximum smoothness
- F#m7b5 (A-Eb) → B7 (A-D#, A stays!) → Em (G-B) — same economy in the E minor cycle
- Add LH root: put it together, hands together at 70 BPM through full sequence

4

SECTION 4

Jamming / Free Play — Longy + Groove

10 min

FREE VOICING OVER I-IV-V-I — PIANO EXPLORATION STAGE 2

5 min

- LH: play I-IV-V-I in G major (G-C-D-G), blocked chords, 4 beats each at 80 BPM
- RH: improvise freely using only G major scale (G-A-B-C-D-E-F#)
- Do not plan. Listen to what happens: does your RH want to move when V arrives?
- **Sing before you play** — hum each melody idea before playing it

LONGY RHYTHM APPLIED — PIANO ACCOMPANIMENT PATTERN STAGE 2

5 min

- Speak "ta . te . ta . ta-te" — this is a jazz waltz-adjacent swing pattern
- Apply: LH plays root on "ta" (beat 1), block chord on "te" (beat 2), silence beat 3, chord on "ta-te" (4+)
- Loop over Am7 for 4 bars, then let it move through the Autumn Leaves cycle naturally
- Feel the swing — the "ta-te" anticipation is what makes it groove

5

SECTION 5

The Synthesizer — Connect + Reflect

8 min

PIANO SYNTHESIZER CIRCUIT STAGE 3

5 min

- Pick the melody note B (bar 1 of Autumn Leaves melody, over Am7)
- Keyboard landmark: B is the right neighbor of the 3-black-key group, top white key
- Zone: B over Am7 = Zone 3 (Color — whole step above A, not a chord tone)
- Behavior at D7 change: B over D7 = Zone 3 still (Color, whole step above A). Float Free.
- Longy position: what beat does B land on in the actual melody? Speak it in syllables.

ONE-SENTENCE REFLECTION STAGE 3

3 min

- What connection surprised you today? (Plogger landmark → actual chord? Zone → behavior?)
- Which system felt most natural? Which needs more time tomorrow?
- Write one sentence in your workbook. No more, no less. Make it specific.

SESSION COMPLETE

Piano Week 1 — 60 Minutes

S1: 10 min Plogger · S2: 18 min Integrated · S3: 14 min Song · S4: 10 min Jamming · S5: 8 min Synthesizer

Week 1 Goals + Daily Practice Log

MY WEEK 1 GOALS (WRITE THESE BEFORE DAY 1)

What does success look like for you at the end of Week 1? Be specific.

Anchor song connection: *What one thing from Autumn Leaves do I want to understand better by end of week?*

Daily Practice Log — Week 1

DAY	INSTRUMENT	WHAT CLICKED TODAY	TOMORROW FOCUS
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
Day 4			
Day 5			
Day 6			
Day 7			

LONGY RHYTHM LOG — WEEK 1

For each pattern, check when you can speak it cleanly without losing pulse. Then check when you can play it.

PATTERN	SYLLABLES	CAN SPEAK	CAN PLAY	APPLIED TO AL
Quarter note	ta	☐	☐	☐
Two eighths	ta-te	☐	☐	☐
Four sixteenths	ta-fe-te-fe	☐	☐	☐
Dotted quarter + 8th	ta---te	☐	☐	☐
Compound triplet	ta-ki-da	☐	☐	☐

CHORD-CHANGE BEHAVIOR TRACKER — WEEK 1

Each day, name one melody note and trace its behavior through Am7 → D7.

DAY	MELODY NOTE	BEHAVIOR AT AM7 → D7	NAMED?
Day 1			☐
Day 2			☐
Day 3			☐
Day 4			☐
Day 5–7	apply to F#m7b5 → B7 → Em cycle as well		

Song Work Log + Weekly Reflection + Synthesizer Check

AUTUMN LEAVES SONG WORK LOG — WEEK 1

Hear before you play — check this box every day before your first note: ☐

DAY	CHORDS WORKED	LONGY RHYTHM APPLIED	BEHAVIOR NAMED
Day 1	Am7 → D7		☐
Day 2	D7 → Gmaj7		☐
Day 3	Gmaj7 → Cmaj7		☐
Day 4	First 4 chords loop		☐
Day 5	F#m7b5 → B7 → Em		☐
Day 6	Full cycle, slow		☐
Day 7	Full cycle + groove		☐

WEEKLY REFLECTION — END OF WEEK 1

Answer these after your Day 7 session. Be honest. This is how you build.

WHAT BECAME AUTOMATIC THIS WEEK?

WHAT STILL REQUIRES CONSCIOUS EFFORT?

ONE MOMENT WHERE AUTUMN LEAVES MADE SENSE IN A NEW WAY:

THE CHORD-CHANGE BEHAVIOR I HEARD MOST CLEARLY THIS WEEK:

☐ Stay Sweet ☐ Turn Tense ☐ Float Free ☐ Sink Deeper

SYNTHESIZER CHECK — END OF WEEK 1

The Synthesizer measures whether the systems are connecting. Answer quickly — first instinct.

☐ I can name the keyboard landmark for any white key without thinking about it

☐ I can speak ta-te and ta-fe-te-fe syllables while playing at 60 BPM

☐ I can identify Zone 1 (Sweet) notes over Am7 by ear — I don't have to calculate

☐ I heard at least one chord-change behavior in Autumn Leaves by ear (not analysis)

☐ I played I-IV-V-I and felt the emotional arc, not just the chord names

☐ My inner ear was ahead of my fingers at least once this week

Score: 5-6 = strong week. 3-4 = solid foundation, Week 2 will deepen. 1-2 = slow down and repeat core drills before Week 2.

Week 2: Deepening + Week 3: Integration Push

2 Week 2 — Deepening All Systems

MORE VELOCITY · DOTTED RHYTHMS · E MINOR CYCLE · BOTH PROGRESSIONS UP TO TEMPO

WEEK 2

PLOGGER — WEEK 2 PUSH

CH.3: ADD ALL 5 BLACK KEYS

Week 1 established white keys. Now add C# (between C and D), F# (first black in group of 3), G# (middle of group of 3), A# (last of group of 3), D# (second black key in group of 2). Total: 12 notes by landmark.

Week 2 target: All 12 chromatic notes named in under 2 seconds, eyes open. Eyes-closed drill begins.

PLOGGER CH.4 — WEEK 2 PUSH

DOTTED RHYTHMS: TA---TE

Dotted quarter = 1.5 beats. Speak "ta---te" with a long hold on the "ta". The dash = time passing. The "te" = the short eighth that snaps the phrase closed. Apply to Autumn Leaves bar 5 (the dotted quarter pick-up). *Sing before you play — hear the long-short before speaking it.*

MELODY — WEEK 2

ALL FOUR BEHAVIORS IN E MINOR CYCLE

Week 1 explored behaviors on Am7 → D7. Week 2: apply to F#m7b5 → B7 → Em. This is the darker second half of Autumn Leaves.

- Hold each melody note through F#m7b5 → B7. Name the behavior.
- The B7 has an active tritone (D#-A) — notes near there will Turn Tense dramatically
- Em resolution: what zone does your note land in after B7 resolves?
- *Hear before you play — sing the E minor arrival before playing it*

HARMONY — WEEK 2

BOTH PROGRESSIONS AT 90 BPM

I-IV-V-I and I-V-vi-IV now need to feel automatic at 90 BPM on both instruments. Guitar: add down-up strumming on off-beats. Piano: add swing rhythm (LH root on beat 1, chord on beat 2). Name the emotional arc of each progression every time you play it.

AUTUMN LEAVES — WEEK 2 THREAD

BOTH INSTRUMENT EXERCISES APPLY TO FULL 16-BAR VERSE

By end of Week 2: play the full 16-bar verse (both cycles, G major + E minor) at 80 BPM on your instrument. Travis picking on guitar. Hands-together on piano. No stops. Hear before you play each chord change — your inner ear leads.

3 Week 3 — Integration Push

SYNCOPATION · TARGET TEMPO 90 BPM · FULL VERSE FLUENCY · BEHAVIOR BY EAR

WEEK 3

PLOGGER — WEEK 3

EYES-CLOSED + SPEED

12-note eyes-closed drill: all notes under 2 seconds. Add random partner quizzing (someone calls a note, you find it). Apply landmark system to chord root navigation on instrument.

LONGY — WEEK 3

SYNCOPATED PATTERNS

Anticipation = playing the "te" before the beat, landing on the "&". Speak: "ta te(rest)ta ta-te" where "te" is an early hit. This is the engine of jazz rhythm. Apply to Autumn Leaves groove — anticipate chord changes one eighth note early. *Hear before you play — feel the anticipation in your body before your hands land.*

MELODY — WEEK 3

HEAR BEHAVIORS WITHOUT ANALYSIS

Week 3 is the ear test. Put on Autumn Leaves recording. Call out the behavior label as each chord change happens: "Turn Tense... Float Free..." without stopping the music.

If you can't hear it in real time: back to Week 1 and 2 drills. This is the honest test. *Hear before you play — always.*

HARMONY — WEEK 3

FULL AUTUMN LEAVES PROGRESSION AT 90 BPM

Guitar: full verse with Travis picking pattern or fingerpicking at 90 BPM. Piano: hands together, shell voicings, Longy-based accompaniment rhythm. Both instruments: chord changes feel reactive (you don't count to them — you feel them arriving).

AUTUMN LEAVES — WEEK 3 THREAD

PLAY THROUGH + IDENTIFY BEHAVIORS REAL TIME

Goal: play the full verse at 90 BPM while your inner ear tracks what behavior is occurring in the melody over each change. You don't stop to name it — you feel it. This is musical awareness. This is what Weeks 1-2 built toward.

4 Week 4 — Pure Integration

NO NEW CONCEPTS. CONSOLIDATE EVERYTHING. PLAY MUSIC.

WEEK 4

Week 4 Rule: Zero new concepts, techniques, or chord shapes are introduced this week. Every session uses only material from Weeks 1–3. The goal is fluency — not coverage.

Guitar — Week 4 Goals

- Full Autumn Leaves verse at 90–100 BPM, fingerpicking, no stops
- Travis thumb completely automatic — zero conscious attention required
- Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 → Cmaj7 transitions feel like muscle memory, not calculation
- I-IV-V-I and I-V-vi-IV in G major at 100 BPM without metronome support
- Name chord-change behavior on any chord in the verse while playing
- Keyboard: 12 notes by landmark, eyes closed, under 2 seconds each

GUITAR WEEK 4 DAILY DRILL

- S1 (10 min): Full Ch.3 12-note eyes-closed drill + speak full Autumn Leaves rhythm in Longy
- S2 (18 min): Zone walk on all 7 chords of the verse + behavior call-out
- S3 (14 min): Full verse play-through, 3 times at target tempo
- S4 (10 min): Free jam over I-V-vi-IV with groove
- S5 (8 min): Synthesizer full circuit, written reflection

Piano — Week 4 Goals

- Full Autumn Leaves verse, hands together, at 90–100 BPM
- Shell voicings through entire progression, no jump greater than a 4th in RH
- LH Alberti-style pattern (root-5th-3rd-5th) on each chord, automatic
- I-IV-V-I and I-V-vi-IV at 100 BPM, name the arc aloud each time
- Hear chord-change behavior in real time without pausing
- Keyboard: 12 notes eyes-closed, landmark system second nature

PIANO WEEK 4 DAILY DRILL

- S1 (10 min): 12-note landmark drill eyes-closed + Longy speak-and-play
- S2 (18 min): Shell voicing chain through all 7 chords + behavior naming
- S3 (14 min): Full verse hands together, 3 play-throughs
- S4 (10 min): Free RH improv over LH Autumn Leaves progression
- S5 (8 min): Full synthesizer circuit, written reflection

WEEK 4 JAM PROMPT — BOTH INSTRUMENTS STAGE 3

Play Autumn Leaves from memory, at performance tempo (100 BPM), with a recording playing simultaneously. Your job: match the groove, follow the changes by ear, and notice when your melody instincts pull toward Stay Sweet or Turn Tense.

Hear before you play. Sing before you play. Start with a 4-bar hum of the melody at full tempo before your hands touch the instrument. This is the final test of whether your inner ear has taken the lead.

SYNTHESIZER FULL CIRCUIT — WEEK 4 STAGE 3

Connect every layer learned this sprint through a single note in Autumn Leaves:

1. **Plogger:** Name it by keyboard landmark. Say which black-key group it neighbors.
2. **Longy:** Speak its rhythmic position in the actual melody (ta? te? dotted?)
3. **Zone:** Name its zone over the chord it's played on (Sweet / Tense / Color / Passing)
4. **Behavior:** Name what happens to it when the next chord arrives
5. **Harmony:** Name the Roman numeral of the chord under it (I, IV, V, ii, vi...)
6. **Voicing:** Name how the chord is voiced on your instrument (root position? inversion?)

This is the Synthesizer. When all six layers connect through one note, you are inside the music.

→ Sprint 3 Preview: The Girl from Ipanema (Jobim)

PLOGGER CH.5 + CH.6

Ch.5: Lap Map — palm-down method, four tetrachord types (Ionian, Dorian, Phrygian, Lydian). Ch.6: Pythagorean Ordering — F-C-G-D-A-E-B, adjacent keys share 6 of 7 notes, mode brightness axis.

MELODY: 5 KEY NOTES + TINY TENSION ARC

5 Key Notes Framework: every melody has 5 structural notes that define its shape. Tiny Tension Arc: compose Z1 → Z1 → Z2 → Z1 deliberately. Bossa nova melody analysis.

Sprint 2 Exit Assessment

Complete this after your final Week 4 session. Be honest — this assessment is for you, not a test. Carry forward only what is genuinely solid.

MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER

- ☐ Ch.3: All 12 chromatic notes by landmark, eyes closed, under 2 seconds each
- ☐ Ch.3: Black-key groups (2-group and 3-group) are instant, automatic anchors
- ☐ Ch.4: Can speak ta, ta-te, ta-fe-te-fe without losing pulse at 80 BPM
- ☐ Ch.4: Dotted quarter (ta---te) feels natural, not calculated
- ☐ Ch.4: Can apply syncopated patterns to Autumn Leaves groove
- ☐ Spoke Longy syllables for the AL melody from memory

MELODY CHAMBER

- ☐ Can identify Zone 1 (Sweet) over any chord in Autumn Leaves by ear
- ☐ Named all four chord-change behaviors in AL while playing, real time
- ☐ Stay Sweet: identified at least one instance in the song
- ☐ Turn Tense: identified at least one instance (likely B7 area)
- ☐ Float Free: identified at least one instance
- ☐ Stability ladder: zones 1-4 feel like locations, not memorized facts

HARMONY CHAMBER

- ☐ I-IV-V-I in G major on guitar at 90 BPM — clean, no hesitation
- ☐ I-IV-V-I in G major on piano at 90 BPM — clean, no hesitation
- ☐ I-V-vi-IV in G major on guitar at 90 BPM
- ☐ I-V-vi-IV in G major on piano at 90 BPM
- ☐ Felt the emotional arc of I-IV-V-I (home → away → tension → home)
- ☐ Recognized vi (Em) as the relative minor world of Autumn Leaves
- ☐ Autumn Leaves full verse progression: named all Roman numerals without reference

VOICINGS

- ☐ Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7 shell voicing chain (3rd + 7th) with voice leading — piano
- ☐ Guitar: Am7 inversions, no jump greater than a 4th between chord changes
- ☐ Voice economy is now the instinct — nearest voicing, not lowest shape

RHYTHM

- ☐ Son Clave 3-2 pattern: can clap and play simultaneously
- ☐ Travis picking thumb alternates automatically on guitar
- ☐ Piano swing feel: chord anticipations land early, groove is alive

AUTUMN LEAVES — ANCHOR SONG FINAL CHECK

- ☐ Guitar: full verse at 90+ BPM, fingerpicking, no stops
- ☐ Guitar: both ii-V-I cycles (G major + E minor) solid
- ☐ Guitar: heard at least one chord-change behavior while playing, real time
- ☐ Piano: full verse hands together at 90+ BPM
- ☐ Piano: shell voicings throughout, minimal motion
- ☐ Piano: heard at least one chord-change behavior while playing, real time

PERFORMANCE READY CHECK

Can you play Autumn Leaves verse from memory at 90 BPM and name what the melody is doing?

Yes = Sprint 2 complete. Not yet = identify the weakest link above, and spend one more week on that link only before Sprint 3.

FINAL REFLECTION — SPRINT 2

Write freely. What changed in how you hear Autumn Leaves after this sprint?

The non-negotiable rule that mattered most this sprint: *Hear before you play. Sing before you play.* Carry it into Sprint 3.